

From “Journey to the West” to “Black Myth: Wukong”, what has kept Sun Wukong timeless?

Recently, a monkey went viral around the world, after the release of the game Black Myth: Wukong. Meanwhile, countless people at home and abroad are taking the initiative to understand Sun Wukong, a classic figure from ancient Chinese mythology.

From Wu Chengen's Journey to the West in the Ming Dynasty to Black Myth: Wukong on August 20th this year, the image of Sun Wukong has remained enduringly popular. So, what exactly gives this monkey such lasting charm? It is Sun Wukong's multifaceted and complex personality, the cultural values he represents, and the flexible presentation methods of his legend.

Character Traits

Sun Wukong's character is a blend of mischief, wisdom, and unparalleled strength. Therefore, in the prologue of Black Myth: Wukong, Game Science deliberately arranged a battle between Wukong and Erlang (the Sacred Divinity) to echo his resistance to heavenly authority and pursuit of personal freedom in the novel Journey to the West. This character trait, which resonates with readers of different eras, has also successfully touched audiences of different cultures and nationalities.

Similarly, Wukong's playful mischief under the Black Wind Mountain pretending to be a peach, his kindness in Sandgate Village on Yellow Wind Ridge, and his unwavering belief when facing Yellowbrow in The New West all contribute to making the image of Sun Wukong stereoscopic and rich.

Cultural Significance

Sun Wukong represents key values in Chinese culture, such as loyalty, courage, and the pursuit

of truth. In Journey to the West, his journey alongside Xuan Zang to seek for Buddhist scriptures symbolizes the path to spiritual growth and the overcoming of personal evils. In Black Myth: Wukong, the journey of The Destined One perfectly fits perfectly with Joseph Campbell's "Hero's Journey" theory, demonstrating heroic courage and facing various encounters, presenting the depth of life to the players. All of these spirits and beliefs have become the immortal legacy of the global world.

Narrative Flexibility

Sun Wukong's story is inherently adaptable, allowing for reinterpretations that reflect societal changes and technological advancements. From animated series like Monkey King: Hero Is Back to feature films such as A Chinese Odyssey, and now to video games like Black Myth: Wukong, the Monkey King's tale has been reimaged to fit new mediums. This adaptability ensures that Sun Wukong appealing to new generations while retaining the core elements that made him a legendary figure.

In conclusion, Sun Wukong's timeless appeal lies in his dynamic character, cultural significance, and narrative adaptability. As the story in the Journey to the West that Sun Wukong eventually made the Victorious Fighting Buddha, a form of immortality, the artistic image of the Monkey King has become a symbol of rebellion, wisdom, and spiritual growth, making him an enduring figure in both literature and popular culture, which inspire billions of people. Whether in the pages of Journey to the West or in the digital realms of Black Myth: Wukong, Sun Wukong's legacy endures, proving that some stories are truly great and immortal.